

Visa to integrate open source blockchain tech for B2B payment

Visa is partnering with IBM to integrate a Hyperledger Fabric framework for B2B blockchain payments. This service, which is called B2B Connect, will be introduced in the first quarter of 2019. The tokenisation process will be followed to send a participant's information (including account numbers and other sensitive data) with a unique identifier to facilitate faster transactions that are less susceptible to fraud. Fundamentally, cross-border corporate transactions sent through B2B Connect are processed from the bank of origin directly to the receiver at the beneficiary bank.

Hosted by the Linux Foundation, the Hyperledger Fabric was first developed by IBM and New York-based industry startup Digital Asset as a blockchain framework. The formal release of this production-ready software, the Hyperledger Fabric 1.0, happened last year.



Including the Hyperledger Fabric's functionality into Visa's core assets will help improve and facilitate financial transactions on a scalable permissioned network to ensure "a frictionless cross-border payment experience with utmost security, trust and transparency," sources at Visa said.

IBM Blockchain Services general manager Jason Kelley said, "IBM Blockchain Platform and Hyperledger technology are delivering real business value today and B2B Connect is one of the most powerful examples to date of how blockchain is transforming payments."

technologies and 70+ tools in all major areas – including COTS, Big Data, legacy, mobile, custom software and cloud technologies. The platform can also drive a scriptless 'automation first' culture that enables teams to promote any artefact through its life cycle, right from development to production, with the assurance to achieve continuous deployment when necessary.

With this, it is possible to provide real-time visibility through cognitive insights on processes and code across value streams, facilitating effective decision making across stakeholders. This helps business teams quickly relay the end user feedback on the applications and services. The platform ensures governance and data privacy through role based DevOps workflows and encrypted jobs as well as security integrations that help uncover vulnerabilities early in the development life cycle.

U.B. Pravin Rao, COO, Infosys, said, "Enterprises pursuing digital transformation require Agile and DevOps at scale to rapidly adopt new technologies, transform legacy systems and respond swiftly to new requirements. With Infosys' DevOps Platform, our clients have achieved a reduction of build and deployment cycle times by up to 50 per cent, near zero environment issues, and improved application quality. With this open source platform, clients can innovate faster with the open source community and mutually benefit from the shared experiences."

StarlingX open source edge cloud software first release is available now

The first release of the StarlingX open source edge computing and IoT cloud platform is out. This platform is optimised for low latency and high performance applications. The project is supported by the OpenStack Foundation (OSF) and its code is contributed by Wind River and Intel Corporation. Some important capabilities of this platform are listed below.

Configuration management: The code used in this platform offers new node configuration and inventory management services with auto-discovery. This is important for deploying and managing large numbers of remote or hard-to-access sites. The Horizon graphical user interface and a command line interface manage the inventory of CPUs, GPUs, memory, huge pages and crypto/compression hardware.

Fault management: This framework allows you to set, clear and query custom alarms and logs for significant events for both infrastructure nodes as well as virtual resources such as VMs and networks. You can access the 'Active Alarm List' and the 'Active Alarm Counts Banner' on the Horizon GUI.

Host management: The software provides life cycle management functionalities to manage host machines via a REST API interface. This vendor-neutral tool detects host failures and initiates automatic recovery by providing monitoring and alarms



for cluster connectivity, critical process failures, resource utilisation thresholds and hardware faults. The tool also interfaces with the board

management controller for out-of-band reset, power-on/off and hardware sensor monitoring. It shares the host state with other StarlingX components.

Service management: StarlingX offers life cycle management of services by providing high availability through redundancy models like N+M or N across multiple nodes. The service supports the use of multiple messaging paths to avoid split-brain communication failures as well as active or passive monitoring to specify the impact of a service failure with a fully data-driven architecture.

Software management: This service allows users to deploy updates for corrective content and new functionality with a consistent mechanism applicable for all infrastructure stacks from the kernel up to OpenStack services. The module